

Achieving Hundred Per Cent Growth with Open Source!

Making money out of something that is free is not child's play. But companies like Taashee Linux Services are encouraging examples of organisations that can make money out of open source technology. The business strategy, however, has to be really strong. **Diksha P Gupta** from *Open Source For You* magazine spoke to **Manoj Kumar Garg, co-founder and COO of Taashee Linux Services**, to learn more about the firm's entrepreneurial journey. Read on...



Manoj Kumar Garg, co-founder and COO of Taashee Linux Services

Linux is not only an increasingly popular technology, but is also a business proposition for many. Despite being 'free' software, it is a source of moolah for many companies across the globe. Taashee Linux Services is one such firm making it big in the world of Linux.

Speaking to *Open Source For You*, Manoj Kumar Garg, co-founder and COO, Taashee Linux Services, revealed the company's strategy for promoting open source technology in the Indian market, particularly among enterprises and SMEs. He said, "The Indian market is customer driven, and I think most customers want to save money without compromising on the quality of the product. Our firm started out with Linux services initially

because Linux was more popular among enterprises as a cost effective alternate to proprietary and expensive software. Now, even though we offer solutions around the entire infrastructure, the cloud and middleware stack, we still retain 'Linux Services' as a part of our company's name because Linux is still the underlying technology for most of the open source software. Besides, we got lot of appreciation from our customers, partners and peers, and hence have been encouraged to continue in the same way. In a nutshell, our only strategy is to foresee the importance of upcoming technologies and keep ourselves ready with some of the next big things (if not all), so that we are well prepared to offer our customers the relevant services when there is a demand for those technologies."

Companies like Taashee have the scope to grow today primarily because of the revamped image of open source technology, which is gradually becoming the sole choice for many functions in enterprises and SMBs. Garg throws more light on the company's growth. He says, "There are a lot of factors that actually helped us to reach where we are currently. First and foremost, the message that, 'Open source is enterprise ready,' which the print media (including magazines like OSFY) and other channels are taking to its readers has actually helped us with our customers. Also, a lot of myths about open source not being a commercially viable model have been proven wrong by the success of organisations like Red Hat, EnterpriseDB and others in India. The commitment of the community towards the code is increasing day by day because of reasons like a better collaborating infrastructure with better Internet connectivity across the major cities in the country."

In addition, there have been major OSS-based success stories in some government initiatives in the field of public services (the UID), education and defence. This has attracted the attention of those in the enterprise domain who never thought open source was really capable of managing the